

Online Medical Resources and Search Engines

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Lecture Learning Outcomes

- Enlist the features of online medical and dental resources
- Enlist the features of online search engines



Lecture Outline

- Online medical and dental resources
 1. Evidence based resources
 2. Dentistry databases
 3. Continuing education platforms/resources
 4. Research databases
 5. Government and Institutional Resources
 6. Community-Based Resources/Platforms
- Advanced search engines
- Advantages, challenges and best practices in using online resources

Introduction

- What is the need and importance of online resources for dental education?
 - Access to updated knowledge
 - Evidence-based practice
 - Clinical decision-making support
 - Continuing education opportunities
- Key focus: Trusted resources and search engines for dentistry



Online medical and dental resources

1. Evidence-Based Dentistry Resources

1. Cochrane Oral Health:

- Systematic reviews for evidence-based decision-making.
- Covers oral health-related interventions

2. American Dental Association [ADA] Center for Evidence-Based Dentistry:

- Clinical guidelines, systematic reviews, and primary studies



Online medical and dental resources

2. Dentistry databases

Popular Databases for Dentistry

1. PubMed:

- Most comprehensive database for biomedical and dental literature.
- Over 20 million citations
- Free access to MEDLINE and life science journals

2. Dentistry and Oral Sciences Source (DOSS):

- Covers all facets of dentistry
- Full-text access to top dental journals

3. EMBASE:

- Comprehensive biomedical database
- Strong focus on drug trials and international research
- Covers drug research, pharmacology, and medicine

Online medical and dental resources Cont...

2. Dentistry databases

Specialty Dental Resources/Platforms

1. American Dental Association (ADA):

- Comprehensive resources on clinical dentistry and practice management

2. Dentaltown:

- Community-driven platform with specialties like Paediatric dentistry and endodontics

3. Academy of General Dentistry (AGD):

- Blogs, podcasts, and CE opportunities tailored to general dentists



Online medical and dental resources

3. Continuing Education [CE] Resources/Platforms

1. Colgate Oral Health Network:
 - Over 200 free CE credits via webinars and articles
 - ADA CERP-recognized provider

2. DentalCare.com:
 - Free access to 150+ CE resources
 - Interactive teaching module
 - Patient education tools



Online medical and dental resources

4. Research databases

Comprehensive Research Databases

1. Scopus
2. Web of Science:
 - Interdisciplinary databases for in-depth dental research
3. Joanna Briggs Institute EBP Database:
 - Evidence summaries and best practice information sheets



Online medical and dental resources

5. Government and Institutional Resources

1. Ministry of Health: in Saudi Arabia
2. Center for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) Oral Health Division:
 - Guidelines on infection control and public health programs
3. American Dental Association (ADA):
 - Research updates, clinical practice guidelines, and policy insights
4. Delivering Better Oral Health
 - Essential guidelines for prevention in dentistry



Online medical and dental resources

6. Community-Based Resources/Platforms

1. Dentistry Subreddit (r/Dentistry):

- Community of 70,000+ members sharing experiences and questions
- Peer discussions among students and professionals
- Informal but useful for shared experiences

2. Theyoungdentist

- Tips and resources for dental students

3. The Dental Geek:

- Articles by practicing dentists with practical tips on patient care



Advanced Search Engines

1. Google Scholar:

- Free access to scholarly articles, theses, and technical reports

2. Web of Science:

- Powerful combination of citation indexing and web technology

3. Scopus

4. Trip Pro:

- Evidence-based healthcare resources, including guidelines and systematic reviews



Advantages of Online Resources

- 24/7 Access to updated information anytime
- Support evidence-based clinical decisions
- Opportunities for lifelong learning through CE courses
- Access to a global community of dental professionals



Challenges in Using Online Resources

- Information overload
- Identifying trustworthy sources
- Time management in navigating multiple platforms



Conclusions and Best Practice for Using Online Resources

- Always verify the credibility of sources
- Use trusted platforms like PubMed, Cochrane Oral Health, ADA
- Combine specialty platforms (e.g., Dentaltown) with general databases
- Stay updated with CE opportunities from DentalCare.com or Colgate Oral Health Network
- Engage with professional communities for peer support and knowledge sharing

Thank you

- References

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